

1 Chapter 1

Nick's Question 1.1 Proof of lemma 1.8.4

The proof is very nice.

2 Chapter 2

Nick's Question 2.1 In the proof of Theorem 2.4.3 on the bottom of page 34 there are some claims made that I am unable to verify why they are true. First, we are considering

$$X_t = X_0 + \int_0^t u(s)dB_s$$

and here $u(s)$ only satisfies

$$\mathbb{P}\left(\int_0^t u(s)^2 ds < \infty\right) = 1$$

so, as in the Kuo text, this stochastic integral exists and a limit in probability of a sequence of stochastic integrals $\int_0^t u_n(s)dB_s$ where the u_n are simple and are in L^2_{ad} and hence $\int_0^t u_n(s)dB_s$ is a martingale and we know the first and second moment. But for the limit $\int_0^t u(s)dB_s$ we know nothing about the moments. But in this text, it is claimed that

$$\mathbb{E}\left[\int_{t_i}^{t_{i+1}} u^2(s)ds - \left(\int_{t_i}^{t_{i+1}} u(s)dB_s\right)^2 \middle| \mathcal{F}_i\right] = 0$$

and I have never seen this claimed in any other text.

Note that u is bounded (we are assuming localization has been done). Hence, all moments exists.

Nick's Question 2.2 In the proof of theorem 2.5.1, why is it true that

$$E\left(\int_0^t |u'_n(B_s) - 1_{(x,\infty)}(B_s)|^2 ds\right) \leq \int_0^t \mathbb{P}\left(|B_s - x| \leq \frac{2}{n}\right) ds$$

Please explore the mollifier f and f_n . Plot these u'_n and see how could it differ from $1_{(x,\infty)}$.

Nick's Question 2.3 What is the motivation on page 41 behind the following definition of the backward ito integral

$$\int_0^T u(s)d\hat{B}_s = \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \sum_{i=0}^{n-2} \left(\frac{n}{T} \int_{(j+1)T/n}^{(j+2)T/n} u(s)ds \right) (B_{(j+1)T/n} - B_{jT/n})$$

The integral in the parenthesis is the average of u_s on $((j+1)T/n, (j+2)T/n)$.

Let's skip this part. I know nothing on the backward SDE and not particular interested either. It has applications in finance. If you don't do finance, I don't see the point here.

Nick's Question 2.4 (Problem 2.7)

This problem follows easily from Levy's Characterization of Brownian Motion. But I can't figure out how to do this problem with the hint given.

This is a nice problem. The hints is to ask you to find the distribution of $X_t - X_s$ through the characteristic function. Once apply Ito's formula, take expectation and remove the martingale part, you should arrive at an integral equation. Take derivatives, you arrive at a differential equation. The solution for $a_s(t) := \mathbb{E}(e^{i\lambda(X_t - X_s)})$ is

$$a_s(t) = e^{-\frac{\lambda^2}{2}(t-s)}.$$

Nick's Question 2.5 (Problem 2.15)

First we consider the 2 - d Ito process

$$\begin{pmatrix} M_s \\ N_s \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} E(X^p) \\ E(Y^{q'}) \end{pmatrix} + \int_0^t \begin{pmatrix} \varphi_s & 0 \\ 0 & \psi_s \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} d\hat{B}_s \\ dB_s \end{pmatrix}$$

and then following the hint we apply Ito's formula to $f(x, y) = x^{1/p}y^{1/q'}$. We get the following derivatives:

- $f_x = \frac{1}{p}x^{\frac{1}{p}-1}y^{\frac{1}{q'}}$
- $f_{xx} = \frac{1}{p}\left(\frac{1}{p}-1\right)x^{\frac{1}{p}-2}y^{\frac{1}{q'}}$
- $f_y = \frac{1}{q'}x^{\frac{1}{p}}y^{\frac{1}{q'}-1}$
- $f_{yy} = \frac{1}{q'}\left(\frac{1}{q'}-1\right)x^{\frac{1}{p}}y^{\frac{1}{q'}-2}$

Now putting this into Ito's Formula gives us

$$\begin{aligned} M_t^{1/p} N_t^{1/q'} &= \|X\|_p \|Y\|_{q'} + \frac{1}{p} \int_0^t M_s^{\frac{1}{p}-1} N_s^{\frac{1}{q'}} \varphi_s d\hat{B}_s + \frac{1}{q'} \int_0^t M_s^{\frac{1}{p}} N_s^{\frac{1}{q'}-1} \psi_s dB_s \\ &\quad + \frac{1}{2p} \left(\frac{1}{p}-1\right) \int_0^t M_s^{\frac{1}{p}-2} N_s^{\frac{1}{q'}} \varphi_s^2 ds + \frac{1}{2q'} \left(\frac{1}{q'}-1\right) \int_0^t M_s^{\frac{1}{p}} N_s^{\frac{1}{q'}-2} \psi_s^2 ds \end{aligned}$$

I am not really sure where to continue from here. I see that if we let $t \rightarrow \infty$ then $M_t^{1/p} N_t^{1/q'} \rightarrow XY$ so if we took the expected value of both sides then we would partially have what we are looking for since $E(XY)$ is on the left and $\|X\|_p \|Y\|_{q'}$ is on the right. But I am not sure about the other terms. Im guessing the Ito integrals in the right have 0 expectation but I am not sure if that is in fact true since I dont see how it is easily seen that the integrands are in $L^2(\mathcal{P})$.

What I did next was see what $\hat{B}_s$ was equal too and for this we define another Ito Process

$$\begin{pmatrix} B_s \\ \tilde{B}_s \end{pmatrix} = \int_0^t \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} dB_s \\ d\tilde{B}_s \end{pmatrix}$$

and applied Itos formula to $f(t, x, y) = e^{-t}x + \sqrt{1 - e^{-2t}}y$ which gives us

$$\hat{B}_s = e^{-t}B_s + \sqrt{1 - e^{-2t}}\tilde{B}_s = \int_0^t \frac{e^{-2s}}{\sqrt{1 - e^{-2s}}}\tilde{B}_s - e^{-s}B_s ds + \int_0^t e^{-s} dB_s + \int_0^t \sqrt{1 - e^{-2s}} d\tilde{B}_s$$

However I am not sure if this step is necessary.

I will consider this problem by Friday.